

Push 2 / Nuendo Bridge

Windows Installation Guide — Version 1.0.4

Standalone .exe — no Python, no pip, no command line

From version 1.0.4 the Windows bridge is a single self-contained executable. The Python interpreter, every dependency and the libusb USB runtime are bundled inside the .exe. You only need to set up the virtual MIDI ports (loopMIDI), the Push 2 USB driver (Zadig) and the Nuendo/Cubase MIDI Remote script.

What you downloaded

- **Push2NuendoBridge-vX.Y.Z-Windows.zip** — unzip it anywhere you like (e.g. Documents\Push2Bridge). It contains:
- Push2 Nuendo Bridge_vX.Y.Z.exe — the bridge (double-click to run).
- Ableton_Push2.js — the Nuendo / Cubase MIDI Remote script.
- PDF guides (User Guide, Release Notes, Plugin Mapper Guide).

Do not delete the .exe after “installing” — it is the application; run it from wherever you keep the unzipped folder.

Step 1 — loopMIDI virtual ports

- Download and install loopMIDI: <https://www.tobias-erichsen.de/software/loopmidi.html>
- Open loopMIDI and create **four** ports with these EXACT names (type the name, click the + button):

```
NuendoBridge In  
NuendoBridge Out  
BridgeNotes  
BridgeNotes In
```

- Right-click the loopMIDI tray icon and enable “**Autostart loopMIDI**” so the ports exist every time Windows starts.

Step 2 — Push 2 USB driver (Zadig)

- The bridge talks to the Push 2 over raw USB and needs the **WinUSB** driver. This is a one-time setup.
- Close Ableton Live if it is running (it grabs the Push 2 exclusively).
- Download Zadig: <https://zadig.akeo.ie>
- Connect the Push 2 by USB. In Zadig: **Options** → **List All Devices**. Several entries named **Ableton Push 2** will appear in the dropdown — one per USB interface (the Push 2 is a composite device with MIDI and display interfaces).
- Select the **display/bulk interface** — **NOT** the MIDI interface. Identify it by the **USB ID 2982:1967** shown in Zadig (and typically labelled *Interface 0*). Picking the MIDI interface by mistake would replace its standard Windows MIDI driver and break MIDI input/output.

- With that interface selected, choose **WinUSB** as the target driver and click **Install Driver** (or **Replace Driver**). Wait for “The driver was installed successfully”.

***IMPORTANT** — this disables the Push 2 in Ableton Live. Windows binds the Push 2 to a single driver at a time. Once WinUSB is installed, Ableton Live will no longer detect or control the Push 2 on this PC. The bridge and Ableton Live cannot use the Push 2 simultaneously. This is fully reversible — see “Reverting the Zadig driver” below to restore Push 2 use in Live. (macOS is not affected by this.)*

Reverting the Zadig driver (use the Push 2 in Ableton Live again)

- Quit the bridge and close Ableton Live.
- Open **Device Manager** (right-click Start → Device Manager).
- Find **Ableton Push 2** — it appears under *Universal Serial Bus devices* (the WinUSB entry). Tip: View → *Devices by container* if you do not see it.
- Right-click it → **Uninstall device**, tick “**Delete the driver software for this device**”, confirm.
- Unplug the Push 2 USB cable, wait a few seconds, plug it back in (or Action → *Scan for hardware changes*). Windows reinstalls the default driver.
- Launch **Ableton Live** — it re-establishes its own Push 2 connection. If Live still does not see it, repair/reinstall Live so it reinstalls its Push 2 driver.

To switch back to the bridge later, simply re-run the Zadig WinUSB step above. You can flip between WinUSB (bridge) and the Ableton driver (Live) as often as you like — it is a 30-second operation each way.

Step 3 — Install the MIDI Remote script

- Copy **Ableton_Push2.js** into the Steinberg MIDI Remote scripts folder, creating the sub-folders if they do not exist:

```
Nuendo:
C:\Users\<user>\Documents\Steinberg\Nuendo\MIDI Remote\Driver
Scripts\Local\Ableton\Push2\

Cubase:
C:\Users\<user>\Documents\Steinberg\Cubase\MIDI Remote\Driver
Scripts\Local\Ableton\Push2\
```

Replace <user> with your Windows user name. The Local\Ableton\Push2 sub-folders usually do not exist yet — create them.

Step 4 — Run the bridge

- Connect the Push 2 by USB (and make sure Ableton Live is closed).
- **Double-click the .exe.** A console window opens and shows the startup status:

```
[0/3] Plugin Mapper: running at http://localhost:8100  
[1/3] Connecting to MIDI ports...  
[2/3] Connecting to Push 2...  
[3/3] Bridge is running!
```

- The console prints a framed **Plugin Mapper link** (<http://localhost:8100>) and opens it in your browser automatically. Most terminals also let you Ctrl+click the link. Launch the .exe with `--no-browser` to skip the auto-open.
- Keep the console window open while you work — it shows live status and any errors. Press **Ctrl+C** (or close the window) to stop the bridge.

Windows SmartScreen may warn on first launch because the .exe is not code-signed. Click “More info → Run anyway”. The CI-built release is reproducible from the public source.

Step 5 — Nuendo / Cubase configuration

Automatic setup: Nuendo usually detects the script and assigns its ports on its own when you open a project.

If the script does not load automatically

- Open any project.
- Studio → MIDI Remote Manager → **Add MIDI Controller Surface**.
- Vendor = **Ableton**, Model = **Push2**.
- MIDI Input = **NuendoBridge Out**, MIDI Output = **NuendoBridge In**.

Note Input

Set the instrument track's MIDI input to **BridgeNotes** (enable it in Studio Setup → MIDI Port Setup if hidden).

Important — avoid doubled notes

- In Studio Setup → MIDI Port Setup, **uncheck “In ‘All MIDI Inputs’” for both Push 2 ports** — “Ableton Push 2” (Live Port) and “Ableton Push 2 User Port”. Otherwise every pad is received twice.

Plugin Mapper (optional)

- The Plugin Mapper web server is bundled and starts automatically with the .exe — no extra install. Open <http://localhost:8100> (the console prints and opens the link) to create custom plugin parameter mappings. See the Plugin Mapper Guide for details.

Troubleshooting

- **“Could not connect to Push 2”** — Close Ableton Live; re-check the Zadig WinUSB driver (Step 2); reconnect the USB cable.
- **“Could not open MIDI ports”** — loopMIDI is not running or the four port names are not exactly as in Step 1.
- **Push 2 connects but Nuendo does nothing** — The MIDI Remote script is missing or the surface ports are wrong (Step 3 / Step 5).
- **Doubled pad notes** — Uncheck the two Push 2 ports from “In All MIDI Inputs” (Step 5).
- **SmartScreen / antivirus blocks the .exe** — Allow it; PyInstaller one-file executables are a common false positive.

Support

- Website: <https://push2bridge.kaikuaudio.com>
- Issues: <https://github.com/mbourque-mix/Push2Nuendo-Bridge/issues>

Licensed under GPL-3.0. Built with push2-python and the Steinberg MIDI Remote API.